



Tints and shades

As well as selecting colors from the color wheel, also consider the effects of tints, shades, and tones. As a rule, pure hues or saturated colors are more intense, while colors that have been mixed together are less vibrant. More subtle colors can be created by lightening colors using white to create a tint, or darkening them by adding black to create a shade. When gray is added to a hue it creates a tone.

Tints and shades can be used as transitional colors between stronger hues and help to blend one color into another. However, too many muted shades can look a bit lifeless, so ensure you inject some stronger colors into your planting schemes to create highlights.

Creating moods and focal points with color

Color can convey a mood or message, and has a powerful effect on the atmosphere in a garden. For instance, vivid, hot colors, such as crimson, scarlet, magenta, golden yellow, and orange, generate a feeling of excitement, while cool colors like pale blue, pale pink, mauve, muted grays, and blue-greens create a tranquil feeling. Use these colors to produce different moods in your garden, perhaps creating a sizzling scheme of hot hues by the house, and cooler

ABOVE Hot fiery border

Hot-hued plants in shades of red, orange, and yellow are guaranteed to brighten up a garden. This fiery border is perfect for a sunny spot.

BELOW Cool pastel shades

The purple flowers of *Salvia x sylvestris* 'Mainacht' and the deeper purple leaves of *Persicaria microcephala* 'Red Dragon' contrast with green grasses and green-flowered *Angelica archangelica*. The silvery leaves of *Heuchera* 'Beauty Color' are also veined with purple, thus continuing the silver-purple theme.



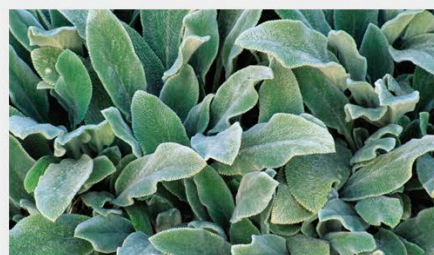
TEXTURE AND PATTERN

Mixing contrasting plant textures creates a lively effect in a border. Combine glossy and matte, or furry and rough foliage to make an impact. Look, too, at leaf patterns and match a variety of shapes and sizes to add to the interest.



Shiny and glossy

Many hollies (*Ilex*) have glossy foliage that reflects light. Their spiny leaves also add impact to a border, or they can be used as focal plants.



Soft and furry

Plants such as lambs ears (*Stachys byzantina*) and sages have a compelling, tactile quality. Plant them at the front of a border where they are easy to reach and enjoy.



Rough and crinkled

The coarse-textured leaves of this decorative vine (*Vitis coignetiae*) are held on twisted, gnarled stems that wrap around its support.



Lacelike tracery

The soft, feathery foliage of artemisia provides a foil for larger-leaved plants that like the same sunny conditions, such as hylotelephiums.